PUW
Przykładowe teksty

1. IQ

The term IQ, or Intelligence Quotient, generally describes a score on a test that rates the subject's cognitive ability as compared to the general population. IQ tests use a standardized scale with 100 as the median score. On most tests, a score between 90 and 110, or the median plus or minus 10, indicates average intelligence. A score above 130 indicates exceptional intelligence and a score below 70 may indicate mental retardation. Like their predecessors, modern tests do take in to account the age of a child when determining an IQ score. Children are graded relative to the population at their developmental level.
What is this cognitive ability being measured? Simply put, IQ tests are designed to measure your general ability to solve problems and understand concepts. This includes reasoning ability, problem-solving ability, ability to perceive relationships between things and ability to store and retrieve information. IQ tests measure this general intellectual ability in a number of different ways. They may test:
spatial ability: the ability to visualize manipulation of shapes
mathematical ability: the ability to solve problems and use logic
language ability: This could include the ability to complete sentences or recognize words when letters have been rearranged or removed.
memory ability: the ability to recall things presented either visually or aurally
Questions in each of these categories test for a specific cognitive ability, but many psychologists hold that they also indicate general intellectual ability. Most people perform better on one type of question than on others, but experts have determined that for the most part people who excel in one category do similarly well in the other categories, and if someone does poorly in any one category, he also does poorly in the others. Based on this, these experts theorize there is one general element of intellectual ability that determines other specific cognitive abilities. Ideally, an IQ test measures this general factor of intelligence, abbreviated as g. The best tests, therefore, feature questions from many categories of intellectual ability so that the test isn't weighted toward one specific skill.
Because IQ tests measure your ability to understand ideas and not the quantity of your knowledge, learning new information does not automatically increase your IQ. Learning may exercise your mind, however, which could help you to develop greater cognitive skills, but scientists do not fully understand this relationship. The connection between learning and mental ability is still largely unknown, as are the workings of the brain and the nature of intellectual ability. Intellectual ability does seem to depend more on genetic factors than on environmental factors, but most experts agree that environment plays some significant role in its development.

2. Languages

In an impossibly interconnected world, where pretty much anybody can talk to anybody on any spot on the globe at any time, it's ironic that our languages are more fragile than ever.
We talk, still. We talk plenty. The problem is, in a shrinking world where different cultures jockey to coexist, homogeneity wins out. Common denominators rule. Languages suffer.
And so, languages disappear.
Around 7,000 languages are spoken around the world according to researchers at the University of Hawaii and elsewhere. That includes the biggies, like Mandarin and English, each spoken by more than a billion people. It also includes Tse'khene, a language used in upper northeast British Columbia, Canada, with just 30 native speakers, according to the First Peoples' Cultural Council.

Dozens of those 7,000 languages are spoken by fewer people than that. The Endangered Languages Project, backed by Google, estimates that as much as 44 percent of today's languages are threatened with extinction. Indeed, many are considered extinct.
"When we look through the rate at which languages change," says Gary Holton, a linguist at the University of Hawaii, "we feel fairly confident that more languages have disappeared than exist today."
That loss stands to accelerate, too, if nothing is done. Some experts estimate that, in the next 100 years, 90 percent of languages will face extinction. In the best case, it may be 50 percent.
The reasons languages evaporate are varied, but near the top of the list is globalization. It's happened for centuries, ever since trade began and different societies and cultures — with their different languages — collided. The bigger culture's language gets adopted. In time, young people learn that language instead of their native tongue.
Eventually, a language is lost.
The process is sometimes forced, too. Throughout history, societies have physically imposed their culture on others. In British Columbia, for example, governments forced native peoples to go to government schools and learn English or French. It was forbidden to speak another language. As a result, only 34 First Nations languages in British Columbia still exist. Thirteen are spoken by fewer than 50 people each.
Fortunately, groups across the globe are busy trying to catalog, preserve and even revitalize these dying languages.
In many cases, it's a race against time.

3. Evolution of Language

The evolution of language is a fascinating subject that has puzzled scholars for centuries. While the exact origins of language are unknown, there are many theories about how it evolved. In this essay, we will explore some of the most prominent theories of language evolution.
One of the earliest theories of language evolution was proposed by the philosopher Plato. He believed that language was a gift from the gods and that humans were simply the vessels through which this gift was transmitted. This view was later rejected by linguists who believed that language was a natural development of the human brain.
Another theory of language evolution is the vocal theory. According to this theory, language evolved from the vocalizations that our early ancestors used to communicate with one another. As our ancestors' vocalizations became more complex, they eventually evolved into the complex systems of language that we have today.
A related theory is the gestural theory. This theory proposes that language evolved from the gestures and body language that our early ancestors used to communicate. As our ancestors' gestural communication became more sophisticated, it eventually evolved into the complex systems of language that we have today.
The most widely accepted theory of language evolution is the cognitive theory. This theory proposes that language evolved as a result of the development of the human brain. As our brains became more complex, we developed the ability to process language. This theory is supported by the fact that language is unique to humans, and it requires a certain level of cognitive ability to understand and use.
There are several key features of language that support the cognitive theory. First, language is a highly complex system of communication that requires a significant amount of mental processing. Second, language is highly adaptable, and it can be used to communicate a wide variety of ideas and concepts. Third, language is capable of conveying abstract and symbolic ideas, such as emotions, beliefs, and values.
One of the most important developments in the evolution of language was the development of syntax. Syntax is the set of rules that govern how words are combined

to form sentences. The development of syntax allowed for the creation of complex, multi-layered sentences, which greatly expanded the range of ideas that could be communicated through language.

Another important development was the creation of writing systems. Writing allowed for the preservation and transmission of language over long periods of time, which facilitated the development of culture and civilization. Writing also allowed for the creation of more complex and abstract forms of communication, such as literature and philosophy.

In conclusion, the evolution of language is a complex and multifaceted process that is still not fully understood. While there are many theories about how language evolved, the cognitive theory is currently the most widely accepted. The development of syntax and writing were two key milestones in the evolution of language, which allowed for the creation of complex and sophisticated systems of communication.